



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Boone Prairie School

School Website: <https://www.adventlutheran.org/school/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Boone Prairie School in 46077, operating as Advent Lutheran Classical School (ALCS) in Zionsville, Indiana, presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning formation model. Public-facing materials emphasize theological grounding, formation of virtue and wisdom, and a liberal-arts framework, with explicit mission language tying character formation to a Christian catechetical context. The school communicates classical aims (e.g., “classical education” and “liberal arts tradition”) and emphasizes formation, spiritual formation, and parental engagement, while offering small-class instruction and opportunities for family involvement. Taken together, the school demonstrates strong Classical tendencies with Christian distinctives, yielding a Overall assessment of Somewhat Classical. The strongest evidence of classical orientation lies in explicit religious/metaphysical foundations and formation-focused aims; the curriculum and pedagogy are less explicitly detailed in the public materials (e.g., explicit Great Books or the full Trivium/Quadrivium scaffolding is not spelled out on the site), though the Liberal Arts emphasis and classical wording are clear. The aggregate pattern across six categories suggests a robust classical orientation tempered by strong Christian formation, placing the school in the Somewhat Classical category rather than fully Classical.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes loyalty to Jesus Christ and Lutheran catechesis.
- Spiritual formation is a named component of student life.
- Public materials frame education within a Christian, Lutheran context and classical framework.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present in public materials: theology, catechesis, Lutheran, gospel/faith, spiritual formation, sacred/orthodox framing (per lexicon expectations). These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essentials lexicon (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations cluster).
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no secular or relativistic signals observed in the site excerpts).
- Why this rating
- The school publicly grounds its mission in Christian theology and catechetical formation, with explicit religious framing and communal spiritual practices represented in the materials. This aligns with Transcendental moral realism and Grounded in Theology signals from the classical lexicon, yielding CLASSICAL-level alignment in this dimension. The absence of secular signals supports a conservative reading of this category as CLASSICAL-leaning, though the explicit liturgical practices are not richly documented in the site excerpts; thus, a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation accounts for the available textual evidence.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence



- The mission speaks of forming hearts, minds, and habits for loyalty to Christ, signaling formation of virtue and wisdom, not merely job-prep.
- The site describes education as part of a liberal-arts tradition, emphasizing virtue, wisdom, and love for learning.
- Public statements (What We Do / What is Classical Education) frame aims in terms of wisdom, eloquence, and virtue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, liberal arts tradition, classical education (mapped to Positive Keywords in the Six Elements lexicon).
- Negative keywords: not evident in the public materials; there is no explicit emphasis on workforce-readiness or skills-centric goals.
- Why this rating
- The school foregrounds formation (virtue, wisdom) and a classical liberal-arts orientation rather than vocational or job-prep aims, aligning strongly with Classical expectations for School Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site communicates a classical framing (e.g., “What is Classical Education? Wisdom, eloquence, and virtue,” and references to a Liberal Arts tradition).
- Public materials emphasize classical aims and the liberal-arts orientation, though explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or the full Trivium/Quadrivium scaffolding is not spelled out on the site excerpts.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Liberal Arts tradition, classical education, wisdom/virtue framing. These map to Positive Keywords in the Curriculum cluster (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, interdisciplinary/harmony, integration and wonder).
- Negative keywords present: Lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium references in public site text. The Six Elements documents specify the importance of Great Books and explicit liberal-arts components; those explicit elements are not clearly evidenced on the ALCS site excerpts.
- Why this rating
- There is clear classical framing and liberal-arts emphasis, but the publicly visible curriculum details do not consistently demonstrate explicit Great-Books engagement or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium scaffolding. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL evaluation for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site emphasizes formation and classical framing, and mentions spiritual formation as part of student life. Explicit mention of Socratic dialogue, scholé, or singing/chanting as pedagogy is not evident in the public pages.
- The Six Elements lexicon presents clear pedagogical practices (Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, etc.). However, the Advent site does not publish explicit use of Socratic seminars, chants, or formal recitation as part of its pedagogy in the accessible materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present (in the lexicon sense) include: contemplative/restful learning (scholé), Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation, etc. The public ALCS materials mention formation and “classical education” but do not clearly show these specific methods. This yields a partial alignment with the Pedagogy Positive Keywords and a partial absence of explicit Pedagogy signals.
- Negative keywords: absence of explicit Socratic seminars, chanting, or rigorous project-based emphasis in the public text. The absence is a signal for a not-fully-classical pedagogy reading.
- Why this rating
- The school leans into classical aims and formation but does not publicly document the full range of classical teaching methods (Socratic seminars, scholé, chant/memory work) in the accessible materials. Therefore, the Pedagogy dimension is best read as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials reference small class sizes and one-on-one instruction as a feature, suggesting strong teacher-student mentorship.
- The site frames the school as a disciplined, formation-focused environment with teachers playing a central role in character formation, though explicit “living curriculum” portraits or teacher-portrait language is not publicly shown.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor, smaller class sizes, personalized instruction. These map to Positive Keywords in the Faculty cluster (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher).
- Negative keywords: explicit statements about “faculty as authorities of modern pedagogy” or non-classical teaching profiles are not visible in the public materials. The absence of such language supports a more favorable view than a strongly negative one.
- Why this rating
- The evidence suggests an emphasis on virtue-driven instruction and close teacher-student interaction (class sizes and tailored instruction), aligning with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Faculty, though the site does not detail a formal “living curriculum” portrait or explicit faculty culture statements.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site describes community-oriented events and opportunities for family involvement via admissions, open houses, and tours (parents welcome at events). Public text invites families to Open House, shadow days, and campus visits.
- There is a stated emphasis on forming partnerships with families and fostering parental engagement within the broader classical framework, as reflected by the public materials and references to Lutheran Christian formation in the learning community.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental engagement, school visits Open House, family involvement (mapped to Positive Keywords in Parents & Community).

- Negative keywords: none in the public materials; some entries in the Six Elements lexicon discuss negative signals such as consumerism or lack of family partnership; ALCS materials appear to emphasize family involvement rather than absence of it.
- Why this rating
- The materials clearly promote parental engagement and open access to visits, which aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the Parents & Community dimension. The depth and breadth of parental formation activities beyond visits (e.g., book studies, deeper parental education) are not extensively documented in the public materials, hence not CLASSICAL for this category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicit Great Books and Great Conversation: Add clear, public articulation of engagement with Great Books, primary sources, and classic texts (e.g., a stated Great Conversation framework) across grade bands. This would strengthen Element 3 substantially.
- Explicit Seven Liberal Arts scaffolding: Publicly describe Trivium components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium components (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) in curriculum and pedagogy sections (even if some elements are implicit, naming them publicly helps).
- Scholé and chant/memory work: Include documented use of contemplative/restful learning days (Scholé), memorization/recitation practices, and, where appropriate, chanting or liturgical memory in lower grades, with teacher guidance and assessment.
- Formal “living curriculum” portrait: Publish a clear description of faculty as mentors and the “living curriculum” in practice, including teacher development, model exemplars, and community expectations.
- Expanded parental formation programs: Provide structured parent-education offerings (e.g., book studies, classical education seminars) beyond open houses, and document partnerships with families as co-educators in public materials.
- Greater articulation of history and Great Books within the history/arts integration: Emphasize cross-disciplinary treatment of history, philosophy, literature, and the sciences as a unified, classical curriculum with explicit Great-Books orientation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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